1. IOD phenomenon is characterised by a difference in sea surface temperature between tropical Western Indian Ocean and tropical Eastern Pacific Ocean.
2. An IOD phenomenon can influence an El Nino's impact on the monsoon.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans : (b) Statement 1 is not correct: The Indian Ocean Dipole is an irregular oscillation of sea-surface temperatures in which the western Indian ocean becomes alternately warmer and then colder than the eastern part of the Ocean.
Statement 2 is correct : An IOD can either aggravate or weaken the impact of EL NINO on Indian Monsoon. If there is a positive IOD. It can bring good rains to India despite an EL Nino year.

• Transport

17. If you travel by road from Kohima to Kottayam, what is the minimum number of States within India through which you can travel, including the origin and the destination?

(a) 6 (b) 7
(c) 8 (d) 9

Ans : (b) The shortest route from Kohima (Nagaland) to Kottayam (Kerala) passes through the following states : Nagaland- Assam-West Bengal- Odisha-Andhra Pradesh- Tamil Nadu-Kerala.

WORLD GEOGRAPHY

• Hydrosphere

18. Mediterranean Sea is a border of which of the following countries?

1. Jordan 2. Iraq
3. Lebanon 4. Syria

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

(a) 1, 2 and 3 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 3 and 4 only (d) 1, 3 and 4 only

Ans : (c) The countries with coastlines on the Mediterranean sea are Albania, Algeria, Bosnia & Herzegovina, Croatia, Cyprus, Egypt, France, Greece, Israel, Italy, Lebanon, Libya, Malta, Morocco, Monaco, Montenegro, Slovenia, Spain, Syria, Tunisia and Turkey. In addition, the Gaza strip and the British overseas Territories of Gibraltar and Akrotiri and Dhekelia have coastlines on the sea. On the Eastern shore, Turkey, Syria, Lebanon and Israel have their coastline on the Mediterranean Sea.

19. Consider the following in respect of Indian Ocean Naval Symposium (IONS):

1. Inaugural IONS was held in India in 2015 under the chairmanship of the Indian Navy.
2. IONS is a voluntary initiative that seeks to increase maritime co–operation among navies of the littoral states of the Indian Ocean Region.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans : (b) The Indian Ocean Naval Symposium (IONS) is a voluntary initiative that seeks to increase maritime co-operation among navies of the littoral states of the Indian Ocean Region by providing an open & inclusive forum for discussion of regionally relevant maritime issues.
There are 35 members- navies of the IONS, which have been geographically grouped into the following four sub regions : South Asian Literates, West Asian Littorals, East African Littorals, South East Asian and Australian Littorals.
The inaugural IONS-2008 was held in New Delhi, India on 14 February 2008. CNS, Indian Navy was designated the chairman of IONS for the period 2008-10. The theme of the IONS-2008 was contemporary Trans- national challenges-International maritime connectivity. Hence statement 2 is correct and statement 1 is not correct.

INDIAN POLITY & CONSTITUTION

• Constitutional Development of India

20. Which one of the following is not a feature of Indian federalism?

(a) There is an independent judiciary in India.
(b) Powers have been clearly divided between the Centre and the States.
(c) The federating units have been given unequal representation in the Rajya Sabha.
(d) It is the result of an agreement among the federating units.

Ans : (d) The phrase 'Union of states' has been preferred to 'federation of states' for two reasons: one, the Indian federation is not the result of an agreement among the states like the American Federation, and two, the states have no right to secede from the federation.
The federation is a union because it is indestructible. The country is an integral whole and divided into different states only for the convenience of administration.

21. In the context of Indian history, the principle of 'Dyarchy (diarchy)' refers to

(a) Division of the central legislature into two houses.
(b) Introduction of double government i.e., Central and State governments.
(c) Having two sets of rulers; one in London and another in Delhi.
(d) Division of the subjects delegated to the provinces into two categories.

Ans : (d) Lord Chelmsford the viceroy and Edwin Montagu, the Secretary of state, in 1918, introduced constitutional reforms which led to the enactment of the Government of India Act of 1919.

- The provincial legislative councils were enlarged and the majority of their members were to be elected.
- Under the system of Diarchy the provincial governments were given more powers.
- Under Diarchy some subjects, such as finance and law and order remained under the direct control of the governor and were called reserved subjects.
- Other subjects such as education public health, by ministers responsible to the legislatures and were called 'transferred' subject.

22. Which one of the following objectives is not embodied in the Preamble to the Constitution of India?

(a) Liberty of thought (b) Economic liberty
(c) Liberty of expression (d) Liberty of belief

Ans : (b) The preamble secures to all citizens of India liberty of thought, expression, belief, faith and worship through their fundamental rights, enforceable in a court of law, in case of violation. The ideals of liberty, equality and fraternity in our preamble have been taken from the French Revolution (1789-1799).

23. The mind of the makers of the Constitution of India is reflected in which of the following?

(a) The Preamble
(b) The Fundamental Rights
(c) The Directive Principles of State Policy
(d) The Fundamental Duties

Ans : (a) In the *Berubari Union case* (1960) the Supreme Court Said that the preamble shows the general purposes behind the several provisions in the constitution and is thus a key to the minds of the makers of the constitution.

24. Democracy's superior virtue lies in the fact that it calls into activity

(a) the intelligence and character of ordinary men and women.
(b) the methods for strengthening executive leadership.
(c) a superior individual with dynamism and vision.
(d) a band of dedicated party workers.

Ans : (a) According to John Stuart Mill, the objective of government as per his views, being the attainment of values and virtue in men, their self development. It is essential that the government should be of those whose self development is being sought. The voting right in democracy allows the citizen to exercise his/her choice and ensures adherence of moral values or character. Such as justice and equality. So, option (a) is the correct answer.

• Citizenship, Fundamental Rights Fundamental Duties, Directive Principles of State Policies

25. Right to vote and to be elected in India is a

(a) Fundamental Right (b) Natural Right
(c) Constitutional Right (d) Legal Right

Ans : (d) According to Supreme Court judgment Jyoti Basu Vs Devi Ghosal- A right to elect fundamental though it is to democracy, is, anomalously neither a fundamental right nor a common law Right. It is a statutory right. So is the right to be elected and the right to dispute and election.
Note: As per NCERT one of the important decisions of the framers of the Indian Constitution was to guarantee every adult citizen in India, the right to vote i.e. universal adult franchise. Article 326 of the Constitution provides for the right to vote and to be elected in India. What is true of the right to vote is also true of the right to contest the election. All citizens have the right to contest for election and become the representative of the people.

26. Which of the following are envisaged by the Right against Exploitation in the Constitution of India?

1. Prohibition of trafficking in human beings and forced labour
2. Abolition of untouchability
3. Protection of the interests of minorities
4. Prohibition of employment of children in factories and mines

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

(a) 1, 2 and 4 only (b) 2, 3 and 4 only
(c) 1 and 4 only (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Ans : (c) Article 23 prohibits trafficking in human beings beggar (forced labour) and other similar forms of forced labour. Any contravention of this provision shall be an offence punishable in accordance with the law.
Article 24 prohibits the employment of children below the age of 14 years in any factory mines or other hazardous activities like construction of works or railways. But is does not prohibit their employment in any harmless or innocent work.

27. One of the implications of equality in society is the absence of

(a) Privileges (b) Restraints
(c) Competition (d) Ideology

Ans : (a) The term equality means the absence of special privileges to any section of the society and the provision of adequate opportunities for all individuals without any discrimination.